



DIRT

TLDR - DIRT

DIRT — Product Specification

Status:  LOCKED

Version: 1.0

Owner: Marketing, Growth & Comms

Source of truth for: product naming, mechanics, asset planning, content vocabulary

How to use this doc

This is the source of truth for everything DIRT-related across the team. Each section is owned by different people:

- **Devs / game designers** → §3, §4, §5, §6 are spec — implement against these.
- **Lore / narrative writers** → §7 launching pad. Seeds only.
- **Art / design team** → §8 asset checklist.
- **Marketing / comms** → §9 reference for vocabulary, angles, and content hooks.

Open questions deliberately left in §11.

§1 · OVERVIEW

DIRT is the **second product** in the DopeRaiders economy, alongside WEED. Players hack it, transport it, trade it across districts, and raid each other for it. Mechanically it's a **direct mirror of weed** — same loops, same risk/reward math,

same raid structure — but it brings a new aesthetic, audience, and content surface to the game.

The duality

	WEED	DIRT
Origin	Grown	Mined
Texture	Organic	Digital
Culture	Dealer	Hacker
Setting	Street, grow room	Server room, terminal

Same empire. Two product lines. Players can produce one, both, or specialize in raiding the rest of the playerbase.

Why DIRT (the name)

DIRT was chosen because it's **already street slang** for stolen / incriminating information ("I got dirt on him"), it pairs verb-to-verb with WEED (you *grow* one, you *dig up* the other), it carries no crypto or web3 jargon, and it's one syllable — instantly lettering-ready for any UI element, headline, or merch drop.

Alternatives considered & rejected:

- **INTEL** — too clean, too military-coded
- **DOX** — too hacker-niche, alienates casual players
- **LEAKS** — too breach-cycle-coded, narrow association
- **HEAT** — collides with police "heat" double meaning
- **FILES** — too bureaucratic, no edge
- **GHOSTS** — too abstract, doesn't land as a product

§2 · THE PRODUCT

Core facts

Field	Value
Name	DIRT
Type	Second tradeable product
Unit of measure	GB (gigabytes)
High-tier unit	TB (terabytes) — used on Tier 03+ drives and Archive jackpots
Parallel product	WEED
Loops	Produce · Transport · Trade · Raid (identical to weed)
Raid minimum	Player must hold ≥ 2 GB of DIRT to initiate a DIRT raid (parallel to existing 2-unit weed rule)

What it is in-fiction

DIRT is **stolen private data** — leaked credentials, intercepted communications, scraped corporate records, ripped databases, captured surveillance feeds. The specific contents are kept **deliberately abstract** by design (see §7 for lore hooks and §9 for what we explicitly don't go near).

What matters in-fiction is that DIRT is **a tradeable commodity with fluctuating district prices**, just like weed. Players are moving valuable, dangerous, illegal information from where it's produced to where it's worth the most.

What it is mechanically

A second commodity in player inventory. Carry capacity, market price, raid mechanics, and bust mechanics all apply to DIRT identically to WEED — no new combat math, no new market formulas. The lift is in **new screens, new icons, new naming, and the drive-tier carry system** (§4).

Unit display rules

- Under 1,024 GB displays as **GB** (32 GB, 128 GB)
- 1,024 GB and above displays as **TB** (1 TB, 4 TB, 16 TB)
- **Inventory totals always display in GB** for consistency: "Holding: 47 GB of 128 GB"

§3 · PRODUCTION CHAIN

The full chain mirrors weed step-for-step:

```
WEED:  SEEDS    → GROWING → WEED
DIRT:  EXPLOITS → MINING  → DIRT
```

Input: EXPLOITS

The **consumable resource**. Players buy them, burn them, get DIRT back.

- **In-fiction:** zero-day vulnerabilities, phishing kits, malware bundles, leaked credentials, hacker scripts. The exact framing is intentionally flexible — they're the digital equivalent of chemicals.
- **Mechanically:** a purchasable consumable, **parallel to chemicals** for the original coke production. Burned on use. Cost scales with district market conditions, same as seeds and chemicals do today.
- **Sold at:** district markets, alongside seeds. Each district can carry slightly different exploit pricing — already supported by the existing market system.

Alternatives considered & rejected:

- **MALWARE** — too broad, doesn't sound consumable
- **PHISHING KITS** — too narrow, only one attack type
- **BOTNETS** — too technical, abstracts away from the player
- **SCRIPTS** — generic, no street edge

EXPLOITS chosen for being hacker-canon, sounding "expensive," and carrying real black-market connotation that the audience already recognizes.

Production verb: MINING

The action verb. What players see in the UI, in chat, and in marketing copy.

- **In-fiction:** extracting valuable data from compromised systems over time, like crypto miners ripping value from raw compute. The metaphor lands instantly with our audience.

- **Mechanically:** a **timed production cycle** (4h / 8h / 24h, matching weed). Output yield depends on **Mining Power** upgrades — see §5.
- **UI parallel:** where weed shows *"Growing 10 Weed (4h remaining)"*, DIRT shows *"Mining 10 GB DIRT (4h remaining)"*.
- **Capacity reservation:** while mining is in progress, the expected DIRT yield is **reserved against carry capacity** — same rule as weed (already documented in existing GitBook).

Alternatives considered & rejected:

- **BREACHING** — too aggressive, doesn't read as "production"
- **RIPPING** — slang lands, but less universal across regions
- **SCRAPING** — technically accurate but reads as boring
- **HACKING** — too generic, no specificity
- **HARVESTING** — too soft, too agricultural (we already have growing for that)

MINING chosen because it parallels the crypto-mining mental model, is instantly readable by the web3-native audience, and gives marketing a clean verb to use across all content.

Output: DIRT

The harvested product. Lives on a **drive** (see §4). Ready to be traded, transported between districts, or raided off the player.

§4 · TRANSPORT — THE DRIVE TIER SYSTEM

DIRT moves physically between districts on drives. **Drive type IS the carry-capacity upgrade tree** — bigger drives carry more DIRT, the same way bigger bags carry more weed.

The 5 tiers

Tier	Hardware	Capacity	Positioning
01	Burner USB	32 GB	Cheap, disposable, street-level

Tier	Hardware	Capacity	Positioning
02	Encrypted USB	128 GB	AES-256, secured
03	Portable SSD	1 TB	NVMe, pro-grade
04	Hardened SSD	4 TB	IP68, shock-proof, military-spec
05	Black Briefcase	16 TB	Vault-class — JACKPOT TIER

How tiers work

- Each tier is an **active upgrade** in the existing Carry Capacity upgrade system — same mechanic as bag upgrades for weed.
- Tier upgrades follow existing **temporary upgrade rules** (4h / 8h / 24h windows).
- Players can hold higher-tier drives without losing access to lower tiers — **the active tier determines current carry cap**.
- **Tier 05 (Black Briefcase)** is positioned as the prestige tier. Best obtained as an Archive-raid drop or a rare market unlock (see §6).

Why drives (and not phones)

Alternative considered & rejected: Burner Phones. Rejected because the visual story is weaker (phone screens are abstract, drives are tactile objects you can show in art), and the tier ladder doesn't read as naturally — a "better phone" is a vague upgrade, while a 16TB briefcase visually beats a 32GB stick at first glance.

What drives are NOT (yet)

- Drives are **carry capacity only** in v1. They don't have separate stats like durability, speed, or encryption (encryption is a separate upgrade — see §5).
- Future versions could add per-drive properties (e.g. "Encrypted USB grants +5% Encryption bonus"). **Out of scope for launch.**

§5 · UPGRADES & DEFENSE SYSTEM

Every existing upgrade type in the game gets a DIRT-side counterpart. **Mental model:** weed upgrades have green / organic naming, DIRT upgrades have cyber / security naming.

Speed & yield upgrades

Weed side	DIRT side	Effect
Grow Power	Mining Power	Speeds up production cycle; increases yield

Alternative considered: "Compute Power." Rejected because Mining Power stays consistent with the verb (MINING) — players don't context-switch between "I'm mining" and "I have compute upgrades."

Defense upgrades

Underlying system	Weed application	DIRT application
Bust Protection	Reduces dope lost on bust	Encryption — same mechanic, themed
Raid Protection	Reduces successful raids	Firewall — same mechanic, themed

The **underlying mechanics are unchanged**. The naming layer is **themed per product**: a player carrying DIRT activates **Encryption** to reduce bust risk; a player holding DIRT in their stash activates **Firewall** to reduce raid success.

Players visually see *"Encryption Tier 02"* or *"Firewall Tier 03"* on DIRT-side defenses, while keeping *"Bust Protection"* / *"Raid Protection"* on the weed side. Same upgrade slot, themed by which product the protection applies to.

Carry capacity upgrade

Already covered in §4. The five-tier drive system IS the carry-capacity upgrade tree for DIRT.

Raid Tie Breaker (RTB)

The existing RTB upgrade applies to **all raids** — including DIRT raids — without modification. No DIRT-specific RTB needed.

§6 · THE ARCHIVE (LockUp Parallel)

The existing LockUp mechanic gets a parallel for DIRT.

Rename rationale

The LockUp is currently framed as a police vault at Vice Island where confiscated dope accumulates. For DIRT, the parallel concept is named **THE ARCHIVE**.

Alternative considered & rejected: Evidence Locker. Rejected because it's too procedural, too cop-show. **THE ARCHIVE** carries weight without committing to a single faction — could be FBI, NSA, a cartel, or something else (lore team's call — see §7).

How it works (mirror of LockUp)

- When a player gets busted carrying DIRT, **half the confiscated DIRT** goes to The Archive's on-chain address
- The Archive **grows over time** as busts accumulate
- Players can **raid The Archive** — 1-in-30 chance of success (same odds as LockUp)
- Winner takes **up to 50%** of stored DIRT, even if it exceeds carry capacity (must sell excess before next market action — same rule as LockUp)
- Winning the Archive jackpot **automatically grants temporary Encryption + Firewall** protection (mirror of LockUp's bust / raid protection grant)

Open question — see §11

Whether the LockUp and The Archive are **two separate vaults** or **one combined vault** holding both products. Both are workable; decision needed before implementation.

§7 · LORE & WORLDBUILDING HOOKS

 This section is a **seeding document, not a lore document**. It lists the threads the narrative team has to pull on to weave DIRT into the existing world.

Threads to pull

The hacker side of the empire

- Who runs the digital underworld in DopeRaiders' world?
- Are hackers a separate faction from dealers, an overlapping crew, or rivals?
- Is there a unifying boss archetype for the digital districts, or is it intentionally decentralized?

District specialization (optional but nahhh)

Each of the 7 districts could specialize in a type of DIRT over time. Suggested seeds — **not commitments**:

- Financial district → banking credentials, trading records
- Medical district → health records, insurance fraud material
- Government district → classified files, identity packages
- Entertainment district → celebrity blackmail, leaked recordings
- Tech district → corporate trade secrets, source code
- Residential district → personal identity bundles
- Vice Island → everything the others won't touch

How hard this specialization is enforced (**mechanically** vs **narratively only**) is a design call. Recommendation: launch narrative-only, layer mechanics in over seasons.

Character archetypes

The art and character work can introduce hacker-side counterparts to existing dealer characters — hooded operators, masked street raiders, kingpins in suits with briefcases. **No commitments here** — just an opening for the design team and lore writers to coordinate.

The Archive's identity

Is The Archive an FBI server farm? A cartel's data vault? An abandoned datacenter the police repurposed? A mythologized place no one's actually seen? **Open question for the lore team.**

Real-world reference points (optional inspiration)

- The Silk Road / darknet market era

- Anonymous / LulzSec / hacktivist culture
- Mr. Robot, Cyberpunk 2077, Watch Dogs, Sneakers, Hackers (1995)
- Real breach culture: LastPass, Equifax, Colonial Pipeline, crypto bridge hacks

These are **NOT canon** — they're tonal references the team can lean on or ignore.

What we explicitly DON'T commit to

- Specific real-world brands, governments, or companies as targets
 - Specific real cybersecurity techniques (no real exploits, no real CVEs)
 - Any framing that could read as endorsing actual criminal hacking
 - DIRT contents that overlap with policy-sensitive areas (CSAM, terrorism, etc.)
— **the abstraction is intentional and protective**
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§8 · ASSET CHECKLIST

What the art / design team needs to produce to ship DIRT. **This is what to create, not how it should look** — visual direction stays with the design team.

Core UI (parallel to existing weed UI)

- ☐ DIRT inventory icon (companion to weed icon)
- ☐ Mining production tile (parallel to weed-growing tile)
- ☐ EXPLOITS market icon (parallel to seeds market icon)
- ☐ Drive tier icons × 5 (Burner USB, Encrypted USB, Portable SSD, Hardened SSD, Black Briefcase)
- ☐ Mining Power upgrade icon
- ☐ Encryption upgrade icon
- ☐ Firewall upgrade icon
- ☐ The Archive location marker on Vice Island map
- ☐ The Archive jackpot screen (parallel to existing LockUp vault-open screen)
- ☐ DIRT-side raid result screen treatment (existing raid screen, themed)

Marketing & content assets

- ☐ DIRT wordmark / lockup
- ☐ EXPLOITS → MINING → DIRT flow graphic for explainer content
- ☐ Tier ladder visual for community / docs / tutorials
- ☐ Hacker-side character archetype concepts (count TBD with lore team)
- ☐ District-specialization visual concepts (if §7 specialization is adopted)

Phase 2 / nice-to-have

- ☐ Animated mining cycle (production timer animation)
- ☐ Drive-upgrade swap animation (Tier 01 → Tier 02 → ...)
- ☐ Archive raid cinematic (parallel to LockUp open cinematic)
- ☐ Faction crests / district crests for the DIRT side

§9 · MARKETING & CONTENT REFERENCE

For the marketing / comms team. Voice, vocabulary, and angles for everything DIRT-related. **Existing brand voice and persona rules still apply** — this just adds the DIRT-specific layer on top.

Vocabulary — USE FREELY

- **DIRT** — the product (always caps in UI; sentence case fine in prose)
- **MINING** — the verb
- **EXPLOITS** — the input
- **DRIVES** — the carry object (general term)
- **THE ARCHIVE** — the DIRT-side vault
- **ENCRYPTION** — bust defense for DIRT
- **FIREWALL** — raid defense for DIRT
- **MINING POWER** — speed / yield upgrade
- **JACKPOT TIER** — Tier 05 (Black Briefcase)

- **GB / TB** — units

Phrases that work

- "Mine it. Move it. Or get it jacked."
- "Same empire. New product."
- "Dirt moves on drives."
- "Encryption holds. Or it doesn't."
- "From burner USB to black briefcase."

Vocabulary — AVOID

Standard brand forbidden words still apply. **DIRT-specific additions:**

- Real cybersecurity brand names (NSO, Pegasus, specific CVE numbers)
- Real-world breach victim names in copy (LastPass, Equifax, etc.) — fine as internal reference, **not for public posts**
- Anything that reads as "hacking tutorial" or "how to actually exploit X" — **never blur the line** between in-game fiction and real-world advice
- Specific real exploits, techniques, or attack vectors

Content hooks

- **The natural pairing** — "*WEED grows. DIRT mines.*" Use this duality in onboarding, explainers, and brand content.
- **The tier ladder is a content series in itself** — five tiers, five posts, five characters.
- **Every real-world data-breach news cycle is a content opportunity** ("*Looks like [district name] left their exploits unpatched 🕸*") — **react to them, don't claim them.**
- **Mining cycle timelapses** — fast-cut content showing 4h cycles compressed to 4 seconds. Native TikTok / Shorts material.

Audience expansion

Adding DIRT opens DopeRaiders to:

- Cybersec Twitter
- Hacker culture / Anonymous-adjacent communities
- Mr. Robot, Cyberpunk 2077, Watch Dogs fandoms
- Surveillance-state-aware / privacy-tech communities

This is additive, not a pivot. Weed audience stays — DIRT adds a second front.

§10 • QUICK REFERENCE GLOSSARY

Term	Meaning
DIRT	The product. Stolen data. Measured in GB.
EXPLOITS	The consumable input. Burned to start a mining cycle.
MINING	The production verb. Timed cycle, parallel to growing weed.
DRIVES	The physical carry objects. Tiered USB → Briefcase.
TIER 01-05	The five drive levels — Burner USB / Encrypted USB / Portable SSD / Hardened SSD / Black Briefcase.
ENCRYPTION	Bust defense for the DIRT side.
FIREWALL	Raid defense for the DIRT side.
MINING POWER	Speed / yield upgrade for mining cycles.
THE ARCHIVE	The DIRT-side vault. LockUp parallel.
JACKPOT TIER	Tier 05 — Black Briefcase, 16 TB.
GB / TB	Units of measure. Inventory always shown in GB.

§11 • OPEN QUESTIONS / DECISIONS PENDING

Things this doc **deliberately does NOT decide**, kept here so they don't get forgotten:

- ☐ **One vault or two?** Combined LockUp + Archive vs separate vaults (see §6)

- ☐ **District specialization** — adopted as mechanic, narrative-only, or skipped (see §7) (???)
 - ☐ **Tier 05 (Black Briefcase) acquisition path** — guaranteed unlock via upgrade tree, rare market drop, or Archive-only prize
 - ☐ **EXPLOITS market price tuning** — needs balancing pass alongside Mining Power values
 - ☐ **The Archive's in-fiction identity** — FBI / cartel / mystery (lore call)
-